

Peer Support Group Community Agreements

We speak from personal experience.

We use "I" statements and avoid making generalizations. We offer our own stories rather than advice disguised as fact. We approach conversations with curiosity instead of assumptions.

We protect each other's privacy.

What's shared here stays here. What's learned here leaves here. We strive to maintain confidentiality around the personal details of participants' lives, and we don't gatekeep on helpful resources and insights you know about!

We're here to build community.

This space is for exploring life beyond work, not for pitching products, services, or resumes. We welcome your life updates, creative projects, and intentional invitations, but not transactional networking or selling services. This is a space to practice. We give ourselves permission to try, to stumble, and to learn.

We acknowledge our resources.

We name the visible and invisible supports that make our lives possible: financial, emotional, communal, and ancestral. This looks like disclosing the help we've received as it relates to the topic at hand. Practicing transparency around money and privilege helps us resist the shame and secrecy that white supremacy and capitalism rely on. It's okay to have support; what matters is that we name it.

We care for ourselves.

We trust ourselves to step away, pause, or tend to our needs. We notice when comparison or one-upmanship arises and return to self-compassion.

We give advice with consent.

We ask before offering suggestions. We don't talk at people. We honor those who simply want to be witnessed. Remember that consent is an enthusiastic yes, not a, "Sure, I guess." We aren't life coaches.

We offer feedback with care and promptness.

We speak up directly and kindly when something doesn't sit right, trusting we're here to grow. Hate speech isn't allowed. In cases of misunderstanding or miscommunication, we encourage open and respectful dialogue. Facilitators are not conflict mediators or mental health professionals.

We honor our ancestors and lineages.

Black, indigenous, and disabled people are our teachers in resting as resistance (Tricia Hersey), decolonizing time (Robin Wall Kimmerer), and dreaming of care rather than labor (Leah Lakshmi Piepzna-Samarasinh). We source our political and philosophical framework from our elders.